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EU leaders' efforts on Iran yield no answers

Tehran, Israel continue to trade missile attacks

By Mark Landler
NEW YORK TIMES

LONDON — As missiles flew between Israel and Iran, diplomats from Europe convened Friday across a table from Iran's foreign minister, Abbas Araghchi, in Switzerland to try to find an off-ramp for a rapidly accelerating regional conflict.

But there were no signs of a breakthrough in the three hours of talks, with a defiant Araghchi saying afterward that Iran would consider a resumption of diplomacy only “once the aggressor was held accountable for the crimes committed.” He did say Iran was willing to speak to the Europeans again.

The foreign ministers of Britain, France, and Germany were left to talk in generalities about the need for continued dialogue, which they hope will forestall a decision by President Trump to thrust the United States into the hostilities.

“We are keen to continue ongoing discussions and negotiations with Iran, and we urge Iran to continue their talks with the United States,” Britain's foreign secretary, David Lammy, said to reporters. “This is a perilous moment, and it is hugely important that we don't see regional escalation of this conflict.”

France's foreign minister, Jean-Noel Barrot, was similarly vague, declaring it was important to pursue a dialogue with Iran because “we be-

MIDDLE EAST, Page A5

Read juror ‘confident’ in verdict

Describes colleagues as ‘bright, respectful’

By Ava Berger
GLOBE CORRESPONDENT

Paula Prado has four young children, so when the verdict that she and 11 other jurors decided in the Karen Read trial was announced inside a Dedham courthouse Wednesday, she began to cry for John O'Keefe's mother.

“I have kids, and she lost two children,” said Prado, 39, of O'Keefe's mother, Peggy O'Keefe, who also lost her daughter to cancer in 2013. “This is devastating. I can't even imagine how she feels. ... I cried for her, for nobody else.”

► O'Keefe family's wrongful death suit against Karen Read set to advance. B1.

Still, the “holes” in the prosecution's case gave Prado “100 percent” confidence that she made the right decision, she said in an interview Friday.

“I'm confident that we did the right thing,” said Prado, who lives in Walpole.

On Wednesday, a jury cleared Read of three serious charges: second-degree murder, manslaughter while operating under the influence, and leaving the scene of a crash resulting in death. The jury found her guilty of a lesser charge of drunken driving. Read will serve one year of probation as a first-time offender.

READ, Page A10

A twist in Harvard, Trump fight

As judge gives school a win on foreign students, president says a deal is near

By Aidan Ryan, Mike Damiano, and Brooke Hauser
GLOBE STAFF

The Trump administration's high-profile pressure campaign on Harvard University took an unexpected turn Friday when the president announced, without any details, that the government has been negotiating with the university and they are nearing a deal that would

prove “‘mindbogglingly’ HISTORIC.”

Earlier Friday, a federal judge in Boston blocked the government's efforts to ban the nation's oldest university from hosting international students, at least for the time being. It was Harvard's latest court victory as the school pursues two lawsuits against the Trump administration: one over foreign students, the other

focused on research funding cuts.

President Trump's post did not elaborate on the negotiations, but provided the first clear signal of any progress toward a deal between the White House and the school, which have been locked in an escalating legal and financial battle since April when Harvard rejected a litany of White House demands to address what the administration says is a longstanding culture of antisemitism, racial discrimination, and political bias at the school.

Harvard has vowed to fight back

and sued the administration both for cutting nearly \$3 billion in funding and attempting to ban international students. At the same time, the school has been responding to document requests and has hired a number of lawyers and lobbyists with ties to the Trump administration, which some see as a willingness to open avenues to open lines of communication.

Friday night, The New York Times reported that Harvard officials visited the White House this

HARVARD, Page A7

FREED FROM CUSTODY



MATTHEW HINTON/ASSOCIATED PRESS

Mahmoud Khalil, a former Columbia University graduate student, spoke with supporters after his release from ICE detention Friday in Louisiana. Khalil, who was held for three months as the Trump administration seeks to deport him over his role in pro-Palestinian protests, was released after a judge said it would be “highly, highly unusual” for the government to continue detaining a legal US resident who was unlikely to flee and hadn't been accused of any violence. A2.

Quibbling lawmakers slow to take action

Mass. Legislature passes just 6 laws in first 5 months

By Samantha J. Gross and Matt Stout
GLOBE STAFF

After a session marked by public finger-pointing and backlogged lawmaking, Massachusetts Democratic leaders this year promised a Legislature that would be more efficient, vowed more transparency, and committed to fighting President Trump's agenda.

But so far, there's been a lot of fighting among themselves. In recent weeks, Democratic leaders have jabbed at each other in press releases.

They've argued about who is, and is not, attending hearings. And they have yet to even agree on rules governing their own operations, let alone on much actual legislation as state-level Democrats fashion themselves as bulwarks against Trump's administration.

In five months, the Legislature has passed just six new laws. And while those various bills allocated hundreds of millions of dollars to the state shelter system or state employee health insurance, they rank as the fewest signed into law at this point in the legislative session in decades, if not longer.

Asked how he'd categorize

LEGISLATURE, Page A7



ERIN CLARK/GLOBE STAFF/FILE

Boston Calling puts itself on hold

Organizers of the music festival would not say why they abruptly canceled next year's edition of the annual three-day event. In a Facebook post, producer C3 Presents said the event is taking a “short break” before returning in 2027. Above, Brad Shultz, guitarist for Cage the Elephant, performed at the event last month. B6.

Russian President Vladimir Putin doubled down on his justification for the war in Ukraine, saying Russians and Ukrainians were one people. A4.

Amid federal funding cuts, the clock is ticking for roughly 3 million biological samples preserved as part of a series of long-term health studies, many of them housed at Harvard's T.H. Chan School of Public Health. B1.

A Suffolk Superior Court judge declared a mistrial in the case of an Irish firefighter charged with raping a woman in a Boston hotel last year. B1.

American Airlines will offer daily direct flights from Cape Cod Gateway Airport to Chicago and Philadelphia throughout the summer. D1.



Beach goers

Saturday: Sunny and warm. High: 83-88. Low: 69-74.

Sunday: Hot, some clouds. High: 92-97. Low: 70-75.

High tide: 7:49 a.m. 8:12 p.m. Sunrise: 5:07 Sunset: 8:25

Comics and Weather, D4-5. Obituaries, C9.

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Gloucester to be Bunker Hill north — ready or not



CRAIG F. WALKER/GLOBE STAFF

A cannon pointed toward the harbor from Stage Fort Park in Gloucester, where the reenactment will take place.

Need for space sends battle reenactment to Cape Ann

By Billy Baker
GLOBE STAFF

GLOUCESTER — Mark Horgan was waiting for a sandwich recently at the Waterfront Café, just across the street from Gloucester Harbor, and the topic turned to the Bunker Hill reenactment that will take place in the city this weekend.

“The owner mentioned it, and I sort of knew a little bit about it, but no one else in there had any clue what he was talking about and couldn't understand why it wasn't happening at Bunker Hill,” Horgan said. “It doesn't feel like many people know this is happening.”

Ready or not, Gloucester is about to find out, because on Saturday and Sunday, the city's Stage Fort Park will play host to the mother of

all Bunker Hill reenactments, an epic 250th anniversary pageant that organizers say may be the largest battle reenactment in state history. It is so big that it simply couldn't work at the actual Bunker Hill site in thickly settled Charlestown.

Picture a thousand reenactors portraying Colonists and British soldiers. Three schooners, standing in for the British Navy, firing cannons from Gloucester Harbor. And perhaps tens of thousands of visitors who are expected to flood the city for the event.

The rebels lost at Bunker Hill on June 17, 1775, in the first major battle of the Revolutionary War, but proved their mettle against a trained British army. The reenactment is part of a wider celebration this year of the begin-

BUNKER HILL, Page A10